

REFERRED CANDIDATES

You Were Referred — What Now?

You were referred. What now?

A referral is not the end of your APC journey. It is the most precise feedback you will ever receive about exactly what you need to do differently. Here is how to use it.

A referral means the assessment panel did not have sufficient evidence to confirm competence at the required level on that day. It does not mean you are not competent. It does not mean you cannot do the job. It means something specific was missing in the way you demonstrated your competence — either in your written submission, your presentation or your answers under questioning.

That distinction matters because it changes what you need to do next. You do not need to become a different surveyor. You need to demonstrate the surveyor you already are more effectively.

The referral letter is your most valuable resource. Read it carefully — more carefully than you have read it yet. It tells you precisely which competencies were unsatisfactory and at what level. Everything you do between now and your resit should be driven by that document.

In the vast majority of referrals, one or more of these is present:

Describing not demonstrating. Telling the assessors what you do generally rather than what you did specifically in a real situation. Assessors need evidence of application — not statements of awareness.

Wrong level of answer. Giving a Level 1 answer to a Level 3 question. Knowing what something is rather than demonstrating you can apply it professionally and advise clients on it.

Weak case study. A case study that describes a project rather than demonstrating professional judgement. Assessors want to see options considered, risks weighed, advice given and outcomes evidenced.

Legislation gaps. Being caught out by a question on recent legislation — particularly 2025 and 2026 updates. Assessors test what is new and relevant to the current window.

Under-pressure answers. Knowing the answer when revising but losing it under questioning. Not having practised being challenged enough to sit with discomfort and think clearly.

Submission errors. Invalid competency choices, insufficient word count evidence, logbook not submitted, case study exceeding word count. Technical errors that cost candidates who were otherwise prepared.

Candidates who go back in with the same preparation and hope for a different result rarely get one. The panel changes. The questions are different. But if the underlying issue — describing rather than demonstrating, Level 1 answers where Level 3 is required, gaps in recent legislation — has not been addressed, the result is the same.

The candidates who pass on their resit are the ones who were brutally honest about what went wrong and fixed specifically that. Not generally better prepared — specifically better prepared at the exact points of failure.

From January 2026, RICS introduced a five-attempt limit for the APC final assessment. If you have been referred once, you have at least four more opportunities. Use them wisely — do not rush back in without genuine preparation.

Typical resit timeline: RICS allows candidates to resit at the next available assessment window — spring or autumn. Most candidates benefit from a minimum of three to four months of focused preparation before going back in. Rushing the resit is one of the most common mistakes referred candidates make.

What to do in the next 48 hours:

1. Read your referral letter in full — note every competency mentioned and the specific reason given 2. Map each reason to the description above — is it a description/demonstration problem, a level problem or a legislation gap? 3. Decide your resit window — this gives you a preparation timeline 4. Do not make changes to your submission until you understand exactly what needs changing and why

The platform is built for exactly your situation. Every module covers the content you need — but what matters most for a resitting candidate is practising being challenged.

Michael, the platform's Michael, has two modes specifically designed for this. Tutor Mode helps you identify exactly where your answers are weak — naming the level, finding the gap, rebuilding the evidence. Assessor Mode challenges you the way the panel will — directly, without softening, with follow-up questions you were not expecting. The candidates who pass their resit are the ones who have been genuinely challenged during preparation.

The APC Sprint is designed for candidates with a window approaching — revision, mock interview practice and Michael coaching across all 11 mandatory competencies in the final weeks before assessment.

The Sprint is built for candidates who know their subject and need to sharpen their performance. £197. Michael in both modes. 42 days. Your next window.

No spam. We will also let you know when autumn 2026 preparation content is updated.

Ready to rebuild properly?

APC Confidence Reset

Six modules of performance reconstruction — from understanding your referral properly to rebuilding confidence, evidence and resit mindset. Built specifically for referred candidates. Updated for 2026.

One-off payment · 90 days access · Updated for 2026